# NAVIGATING CHALLENGES, BUILDING ON SUCCESS

UNDP EGYPT
ANNUAL REPORT
2023

# TABLE OF CONTENTS


| | |
|---|---|
| Foreword | 2 |
| 2023 Highlights | 4 |
| Our Offer | 6 |
| In Egypt | 8 |
| Our Key Achievements | 10 |
| For People | 11 |
| For Planet | 18 |
| UNDP Trends Report 2024 | 24 |
| Looking Ahead | 25 |
| Donors And Partners | 26 |




# FOREWORD

The year 2023 posed significant global challenges. Conflicts escalated worldwide to levels unseen in decades, resulting in devastating casualties and unprecedented migration. Climate change and environmental degradation exacerbated these conflicts, making 2023 the warmest year on record.

In Egypt, these global issues have had a substantial impact. Regional instability and economic slowdowns have adversely affected tourism and foreign investment, critical components of Egypt's economy.

Since April 2023, the number of Sudanese refugees has increased fivefold to 300,000 women, men, and children.

Despite these challenges, Egypt continues to strive for stability and growth amid a complex international landscape while achieving substantial developmental gains.

At UNDP, our primary focus has been supporting the Government of Egypt in advancing social and economic resilience for vulnerable communities. To highlight a few achievements:

The Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprise Development Agency created nearly 500,000 new jobs by improving access to finance for microfinance firms and small businesses, with support from UNDP.

The Ministry of Social Solidarity established Egypt's first national social observatory to enhance social protection schemes by capturing the knowledge, attitudes, and practices of the country's vulnerable populations. UNDP supported this initiative in partnership with the European Union, and together we also assisted in delivering 27 tons of healthcare supplies to Sudanese refugees and host communities.

The Industrial Modernization Center successfully installed 99 new solar power stations in public and private buildings, as well as at world heritage sites and museums, with funding from the Global Environment Facility. UNDP contributed to further advancing Egypt's transition to green energy through this initiative.

The Ministry of Water Resources and Irrigation, with support the Green Climate Fund and UNDP, completed a 69 km dike system in the Nile Delta to protect vulnerable communities and infrastructure from sea level rise.

The Ministry of Communications and Information Technology, enhanced the digital skills of nearly 27,000 women and men, improving their employment prospects with our support.

The British University in Egypt and UNDP, with support from the Ministry of Youth and Sports engaged over 300 students from more than 60 universities in COP simulation models, thereby promoting youth leadership in climate action.

The Universal Postal Union honored Egypt Post as its "most efficient member" for outstanding digital transformation across five services, a program we have proudly supported for many years.

Egypt's commitment to accelerating the SDG agenda was highlighted in key international forums, including the High-level Political Forum on Sustainable Development, due to the Ministry of Planning's efforts in conducting voluntary local reviews and promoting investments in SDGs.

As societies become more polarized, partnerships, increased collective action, and investment in development is more critical than ever.

We remain committed to achieving even more with all of you in 2024 by navigating challenges, seizing development opportunities, and building on successes for people and for the planet.



**ALESSANDRO FRACASSETTI**
*Resident Representative*
*United Nations Development Programme*

# 2023 HIGHLIGHTS

## ACHIEVED BY NATIONAL PARTNERS WITH OUR SUPPORT



# OUR OFFER

## Strategic Plan

UNDP's Strategic Plan 2022-2025 is our development promise. It is our promise to work with a diverse range of partners to support countries, tackle multidimensional poverty, promote gender equality, strengthen accountable and inclusive governance, increase energy access, and build resilience to crises and climate change. It sets out ambitious goals as we work **across 170 countries and territories, so that millions of people can improve their lives**.

## Enablers

Our signature solutions and moonshots are powered by three enablers – **digitalization, innovation and finance** – to accelerate development impact.

## The SDGs

As the backbone of UNDP's offer, our signature solutions contribute towards building the world envisaged by the **17 Sustainable Development Goals** (SDGs). Let's build connections. Let's make a difference. And **let's be future-smart about it**.



## Signature solutions

Our Strategic Plan is centered around **six core development areas**, known as our signature solutions. Through these, we help countries meet evolving priorities, address structural barriers and create opportunities for a sustainable, inclusive future. We work with others to overcome the greatest development challenges of our time.

**POVERTY AND INEQUALITY**
Boosting job creation and social protection, investing in social services and financial inclusion.

**GOVERNANCE**
Supporting rights, accountability, rule of law and people's participation.

**RESILIENCE**
Taking a development approach to conflict prevention, peacebuilding, disaster risk reduction and crisis response.

**ENVIRONMENT**
Supporting policy and financing choices that protect, manage and value natural assets.

**ENERGY**
Increasing energy access for those furthest behind and accelerating the transition to renewable energy.

**GENDER EQUALITY**
Investing in women's economic empowerment, leadership and role in peacebuilding.

## Moonshots

Calling for a level of scale, speed and impact, UNDP has set four "Moonshots" – ambitious goals that we help advance by working closely with our partners: Member States, UN agencies, international financial institutions, civil society and NGOs, academia, and the private sector. Our promise is to support countries solve immediate development challenges and shift underlying structures towards green, inclusive and digital pathways.

**100M** people out of poverty

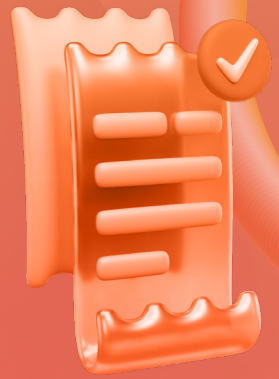
**800M** people can vote

**500M** people access energy

**$1 trillion** for the SDGs

# IN EGYPT

Our Country Programme Document for 2023-2027 serves as a comprehensive roadmap that assesses Egypt's development needs, aligns UNDP's activities with national priorities and Egypt's Vision 2030, and establishes mechanisms for resource mobilization, partnership building, and monitoring and evaluation.



# OUR PRIORITIES

## PEOPLE

### Strengthening Human Capital

We are dedicated to empowering women and men by ensuring equal access to quality services and social justice for all. Our initiatives aim to expand social protection, provide essential services, and promote behavioral changes to combat poverty, inequality, and exclusion effectively. We place a high priority on skills development and digitalization to boost efficiency and ensure that social protection programs reach the most vulnerable groups, leaving no one behind.

UNDP signature solutions 1, 2, and 6





## GOVERNANCE

### Transparency, Good Governance, and the Rule of Law

UNDP works closely with national and international partners to promote evidence-based decision-making. We prioritize ensuring equitable access to efficient services. Our approach includes supporting the government in improving and coordinating financing for the SDGs, enhancing data and monitoring mechanisms, supporting integrated local development, and implementing e-governance initiatives to improve access to data and affordable services for all.

UNDP signature solutions 1, 2, and 6





## PROSPERITY

### Inclusive and Sustainable Economic Development

We are committed to supporting the government in building an inclusive and resilient economy, expanding opportunities for all, especially women and youth, and driving the necessary transformations to accelerate sustainable growth. This entails equipping youth with essential digital and entrepreneurial skills for future employment and cultivating a diversified and innovative MSME sector.

UNDP signature solutions 1, 3, and 6





## PLANET

### Enhanced Climate Resilience and Natural Resources Management

Enhancing climate resilience and efficiency in natural resources management is our top priority. We actively support the country in meeting its obligations under the Paris Agreement as well as its green transition towards renewable energy. Through our efforts, we are helping to improve the quality of life of all people living in Egypt through a cleaner environment, better-protected areas, and sustainable agricultural practices, while also building the resilience of communities and the economy to climate shocks.

UNDP signature solutions 1, 2, and 6





# OUR KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

#FORPEOPLEFORPLANET

## #FORPEOPLE

### Boosting MSMEs and Inclusive Growth

Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs), constituting 98% of private enterprises in Egypt, play a pivotal role in the country's economy, with a staggering count of 3.8 million businesses. The Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprise Development Agency (MSMEDA) has been contributing significantly to job creation, entrepreneurship promotion, and poverty alleviation. In 2023 alone, our collaborative efforts resulted in the generation of around 300,000 job opportunities and the facilitation of 120,000 loans, specifically benefiting women and youth. Noteworthy is the substantial amount of these loans, totaling close to EGP 505.76 million, which underscores our unwavering dedication to fostering inclusive economic growth. Through our support, MSMEDA also successfully established a Data and Market Research Unit and notably enhanced client satisfaction to an impressive 80%. These achievements signify a remarkable stride toward empowering MSMEs and driving sustainable development in Egypt.

### Empowering Vulnerable Communities

The Egypt Network for Integrated Development (ENID), in collaboration with the Ministry of International Cooperation, has been making a significant impact in marginalized communities and investing in women's economic empowerment. By offering training and creating job opportunities, particularly for women, we have helped ignite sustainable development from the grassroots level. To date, ENID has provided training to over 21,000 individuals, predominantly women, across manufacturing, agriculture, and services, tailored to the specific needs of each local community. In 2023, as part of our joint efforts to empower women in the poorest governorates, 120 women beneficiaries aged 18 to 35 gained garment production skills and secured employment at the Jeans Factory, a joint initiative by ENID and UNDP in the Qena governorate. Additionally, women participated in literacy classes and vocational training workshops, resulting in the training of 120 literacy facilitators and 130 women teachers for preschool classes in Qena.



## Egypt Post: Leading the Way in Modernization



Egypt Post has continued its modernization efforts, upgrading nearly 4,400 post offices since our joint project began in 2018. These refurbished centers now boast state-of-the-art facilities tailored to meet the evolving needs of the community. Moreover, 8,226 employees have undergone comprehensive training in diverse areas such as financial inclusion, governance, digital transformation, and anti-money laundering measures, taking part in over 765 workshops organized nationwide. This investment in human capital enhances Egypt Post's capacity to adapt to emerging technologies and better serve the millions who rely on its services daily. The significant strides made by Egypt Post have earned it widespread recognition. In 2023, the Universal Postal Union (UPU) honored Egypt Post as the "most efficient member" for its outstanding implementation of digital transformation across five crucial services. We remain dedicated to supporting Egypt Post on its journey toward continued progress.



## Supporting Sudanese refugees

Since the start of the conflict in Sudan in mid-April, the influx of Sudanese people crossing the border into Egypt reached 83,758 as of May 13, 2024. To assist these vulnerable populations, we worked closely with the Ministry of Social Solidarity and the EU, to help provide and distribute 27 tons of essential healthcare supplies, to those in need at Egypt's southern border.



## Establishing Egypt's First Ever National Social Observatory

The establishment of the National Social Observatory in Egypt, a collaborative effort between the Ministry of Social Solidarity, the European Union, and UNDP Egypt, marks a significant step towards targeted inclusive social protection schemes. This entails building a national database that aims to capture the knowledge, attitudes, and practices of the country's most vulnerable families benefiting from social protection schemes, particularly the Takaful and Karama program beneficiaries, totaling approximately 5.3 million families. The collected data will inform policymaking and enable responsive interventions by the Ministry of Social Solidarity. It is also anticipated to serve as a crucial tool, providing valuable insights into the socio-behavioral changes among beneficiaries of the Takaful and Karama program, measuring impacts in the short, medium, and long terms.

## Enhancing social protection and service provision

The Ministry of Social Solidarity has undergone successful restructuring to provide better social protection coverage, improve access to social services, and expand financial inclusion. A newly developed organogram, approved by the Central Authority for Organization and Administration, has been implemented. Additionally, 4,370 department heads and employees have received training in leadership, customer service, project management, design thinking, and digital transformation through 157 sessions.

We have closely collaborated with the Ministry to implement the Waai community development program, aiming to foster socio-behavioral change among Takaful and Karama beneficiaries. Through targeted interventions, we have raised awareness among families benefiting from Egypt's largest conditional cash transfer program about factors contributing to multidimensional poverty. Our efforts have been instrumental in supporting these families to break the cycle of intergenerational poverty.

Comprehensive campaigns have addressed various issues including family and developmental concerns, health, hygiene, the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic, and the prevention of violence against women and girls.

**These initiatives reached:**

**2M**
Combatting Harmful Practices to Women and Girls, such as child marriage, education, and FGM
- reaching Takaful and Karama families

**2.3M**
Health, hygiene, and COVID-19 pandemic awareness
- reaching through on-ground activities

**54M**
Population and development issues
- with an outreach of beneficiaries

**13.7M**
Ending violence against women and girls
- reaching through contracted media websites

*These campaigns have significantly contributed to promoting positive social change within vulnerable communities across Egypt.*

## Enhanced Institutional Capacities

Government institutions have witnessed notable improvements in institutional capacities during 2023. The Ministry of Planning and Economic Development (MoPED) has developed a Monitoring and Evaluation Manual to streamline evaluation practices across ministries. The manual serves as a practical toolkit and roadmap for government officials to develop, design, and implement M&E systems, offering direct and detailed technical knowledge on the RBM cycle, planning, monitoring, and evaluation. The Ministry of Finance has intensified its internal assessment activities, conducting full-scale internal audit reviews of central departments. Furthermore, the Ministry of Local Development now has guidelines for leadership recruitment at the Ministry and has conducted Human Resources assessments for all its specialized units, including the Human Rights Unit & Equal Opportunity Unit. We helped conduct RBM workshops for 70 government officials representing 20 ministries and government institutions. In collaboration with INP and ENAP University, an evaluation workshop was conducted for 30 government officials to introduce and streamline evaluation practices in the Egyptian government.

## Supporting access to HIV and TB prevention

We supported national authorities in ensuring that 15,000 people accessed HIV prevention packages. Additionally, we helped enhance diagnostic capacities for Tuberculosis (TB), screening over 1,300 TB patients using WHO-recommended Rapid Diagnostic Tools. Furthermore, nearly 1,000 TB patients from vulnerable groups, including migrants and refugees, were enrolled in treatment.



## Supporting SDG Acceleration in Egypt

In 2023, marking the midway point in the SDGs implementation, Egypt renewed its commitment to accelerating progress across a broad spectrum of activities, from localizing and financing SDGs to monitoring their achievement.

Through UNDP's flagship SDGs Insights Report, we assisted the Government of Egypt in leveraging advanced analytics and systems thinking to identify key interlinkages and potential accelerators for the SDGs.

Aligned with national efforts to localize Sustainable Development Goals, Egypt made significant strides in data management and reporting. The establishment of the Egypt Development Portal now serves as a centralized platform for accessing essential SDG data.

In the Voluntary National Review for Egypt 2021, SDG localization emerged as a critical national priority, essential for fast-tracking Egypt's development. In 2023, Egypt undertook Voluntary Local Reviews for three governorates in Egypt, Beheira, Port Said, and Fayoum—through a participatory, multi-stakeholder approach. This commitment to SDG localization was prominently featured in key SDG forums, including the High-level Political Forum on Sustainable Development (HLPF) 2023.

UNDP further bolstered these efforts by enhancing public and private sector investments in the SDGs, advancing an Integrated National Financing Framework in Egypt and supporting the development of a roadmap for innovative sustainable finance instruments. This policy framework, coupled with enhanced capacities in costing and financial mapping within ministries and government agencies, sets the stage for effective public and private financing through 2030.

Building on this momentum, we also helped increase private sector engagement by initiating SDG investor maps for Egypt in 2023. These maps guide private sector investments while promoting impact investing and providing SDG Impact Trainings to encourage strategic investments necessary to drive SDG progress.

Through initiatives like tax for SDGs and insurance, the government continues to foster a collaborative approach to sustainable development and ensuring inclusive progress towards the SDGs.

## Accelerator Lab Spearheads Innovation

In 2023, UNDP Egypt's Accelerator Lab focused on three key areas: "Women & Youth Participation," "Inclusive Access to Finance," and "Sustainable Tourism." Throughout the year, we collectively experimented with over 10 new approaches and tools aimed at empowering youth, enhancing climate resilience, and exploring opportunities for inclusive economic growth.

We engaged women and youth in exploring green opportunities and behaviors using innovative tools such as future foresight and collective intelligence. These methods helped us develop locally tailored solutions to improve access to finance in both rural and urban settings. Additionally, we applied systems thinking and future thinking methodologies to advance sustainable tourism initiatives.

We supported the Government in organizing the second edition of the ClimaTech Run, which promotes environmental solutions through innovation, technology, and entrepreneurship. In preparation for COP28, we analyzed data from over ten thousand climate technology startup applications, uncovering valuable insights for programming and policy making. During COP28, in collaboration with the Ministry of International Cooperation and private sector partners, we showcased resilient climate tech startups to an international audience, fostering ecosystem growth and identifying opportunities for collaboration and regulatory improvement.

Furthermore, we launched a pioneering citizen science initiative in partnership with the American University in Cairo. During the fall semester of 2023, 350 students participated, focusing on water consumption and conservation behavior. In just two weeks, students collected over 4,000 observations and authored 75 reports, demonstrating the effectiveness of collective intelligence in accelerating learning on complex issues. This initiative has been endorsed by the department as a practical approach to engage youth in addressing development challenges.

In 2023, our virtual campaign supported 20,000 home cooks, food content creators, restaurant owners, and businesses in the food supply chain to become more aware of local sources. Through crowd-mapping of local producers, particularly small farmers, we gathered valuable insights. We also conducted surveys identifying signals of change for financial technology (Fintech) in agriculture, laying the groundwork for 'Dream Labs'—workshops where citizens can envision the future and develop innovative finance solutions aligned with their aspirations.

Moreover, UNDP Egypt's Accelerator Lab generated insights on the future of women in agriculture, behavior, and tools to enhance future literacy. We established two new partnerships in 2023: one with the Egyptian Food Bank focusing on the resilience of small farmers and the role of women in agriculture in vulnerable areas, and another with the Knowledge Economy Foundation to support agrotourism efforts.

These initiatives underscore UNDP's commitment to fostering innovation, sustainability, and inclusive development in Egypt, paving the way for transformative change in key sectors.



## Empowering Vulnerable Groups Through Digital Literacy

The Ministry of Communications and Information Technology (MCIT) has empowered nearly 27,000 individuals—both women and men—to enhance their digital skills for more productive employment opportunities. Among these, 6,000 teachers, trainers, and undergraduates have acquired the proficiency to transform traditional curricula into interactive online content. Furthermore, 1,200 persons with disabilities have gained knowledge enabling them to access training services and employment opportunities offered by 1,400 employers and service providers. Additionally, 1,700 entrepreneurs, beneficiaries of the Qodwa-Tech initiative for women in remote and marginalized areas, have been equipped with the latest digital tools to modernize, market, and sell their heritage products on online platforms. Lastly, approximately 18,000 young women and men have acquired contemporary digital and freelancing skills. These joint efforts by MCIT and UNDP represent a substantial investment in equipping women and men with the skills needed for this digital age.



# #FORPLANET

## Egypt's Solar Success

In collaboration with the Industrial Modernization Center and funded by the Global Environment Facility, we supported the implementation of 241 small-scale solar power stations, expanding investments in renewable energy. These stations, with 99 installed in 2023, provide power to various public and private buildings, as well as cultural and historical sites, through the Egypt PV Project. This initiative has helped Egypt achieve a significant decrease in $CO_2$ emissions by 290,000 tons, with an additional reduction of 16,700 tons achieved solely in 2023. The total capacity of these stations amounts to 18.3 MWp, contributing to global efforts to combat environmental degradation and advance towards cleaner energy sources.

Furthermore, in 2023, five solar energy stations were installed at prominent sites such as the Giza Plateau's Visitor Center, Mohamed Aly Palace in Manial, Sharm El-Sheikh Museum, and the National and Royal Jewelry Museums in Alexandria.



*With a total capacity of **325 kW**, these photovoltaic systems generate **520 MW.hr/year**, estimated to reduce approximately **295 tons/year** of carbon dioxide equivalent greenhouse gas emissions. This initiative is part of a broader plan to integrate solar energy across all Egyptian world heritage sites and museums.*

## Expansion of Renewable Energy Share

In 2023, we supported national authorities in driving Egypt's energy transition by facilitating the expansion of markets for on-grid PV systems. This initiative contributed to a notable increase in the renewable share of total energy production to 13% by May 2023. Investing in renewable energy is essential for reducing reliance on fossil fuels and mitigating climate change impacts.

## Empowerment of Small-Scale Farmers

In 2023, we helped implement over 100 income-generating small-scale projects, particularly benefiting small farmers in areas susceptible to sea level rise, with a 64% representation of women. This achievement not only enhances the economic resilience of vulnerable communities but also promotes gender equality and social inclusion. By empowering small-scale farmers, Egypt fosters sustainable agricultural practices, improves food security, and builds adaptive capacity to climate change impacts.

## Enhanced Coastal Protection and Adaptation

In partnership with the Egyptian Ministry of Water Resources and Irrigation and the Green Climate Fund, we completed the implementation of a dike system spanning 69 km in the low-lying lands of the Nile Delta. This initiative is vital for safeguarding vulnerable communities and vital infrastructure from the adverse impacts of climate change-induced sea level rise. By bolstering coastal protection measures, Egypt is proactively addressing the threats posed by climate change, ensuring the resilience of coastal regions, and preserving livelihoods.



## Preserving biodiversity

In 2023, the Ministry of Environment, with our support, took a significant stride by establishing the Biodiversity Finance Policy and Institutional Review. This crucial initiative marked a pivotal step towards identifying gaps and opportunities in biodiversity financing. It underscores Egypt's commitment to preserving its rich biodiversity and ecosystems, which are essential for sustaining life and supporting economic activities such as tourism and agriculture.

After the recent shark attack in the Red Sea, we worked closely with the Ministry of Environment to implement a monitoring system to identify unusual shark movements in the area. This system has been effective in alerting authorities to any nearby sharks.



In cooperation with the Ministry of Environment, UNDP started a beekeeping business for women living in and around the protected area in Wadi El Gemal. Thirty women were trained by international consultants on sustainable beekeeping, including the marketing of the honey produced.

We also helped develop a conservation action plan for endangered species, such as dugongs and sea turtles, at Wadi El Gamal National Park. This plan will help the government achieve its conservation goals and enhance knowledge and management actions for these vulnerable species.

To rehabilitate the gazelle species in the Siwa protected area, a survey was conducted to understand the status of the existing habitat. This survey revealed the hotspots for existing gazelles and identified areas needing attention.



## Highlights from COP27, COP28 and the Loss and Damage Fund Operationalization

UNDP supported the COP27 Presidency by organizing two global consultation/negotiation sessions related to the preparations for the Loss & Damage Fund, a landmark product of COP27. The outcomes of these sessions contributed to the approval of the Loss and Damage Fund on the opening day of COP28. Further, in collaboration with the Cairo International Center for Conflict Resolution, Peacekeeping, and Peacebuilding (CCCPA), UNDP hosted 3 high-level side events at COP28 aiming to strengthen support for Egypt's pioneering COP27 Presidency Initiative "Climate Response for Sustaining Peace (CRSP)".






## Empowering Youth Leadership in Climate Action

In collaboration with the Ministry of Youth and Sports and the British University in Egypt, we helped successfully engage over 300 students from more than 60 universities in COP simulation models, expanding in 2023 to include Zayed University in the UAE. These simulations, which emulate the model UN process, have enabled students to participate in COP28 in Dubai, presenting their findings to senior delegates. This initiative not only provides a practical framework for understanding climate diplomacy but also cultivates future climate action leaders, emphasizing the importance of empowering youth in addressing the global climate crisis.

## Advancing Economic and Spatial Planning

In 2023, significant strides were made in enhancing the capacities of national and local governments for spatial and economic planning. The General Organization for Physical Planning (GoPP), Egypt's national level regional planning body, has achieved notable progress. It now boasts draft guidelines for implementing Strategic Environmental Assessments in urban planning processes. Moreover, there has been a marked enhancement in the utilization of GIS enterprise for multilevel data processing, browsing, and editing.

With UNDP's support in providing capacity-strengthening training on the use of ArcGIS Pro at basic, standard, and advanced levels, 76 GoPP planners have now adopted the GIS enterprise platform with proficiency. This training has equipped them to effectively utilize the platform, thereby contributing to its broader dissemination and increased usage.

At the intergovernmental level, GoPP has three finalized territorial spatial plans; One for Upper Egypt, particularly Beni Suef case study, one for Delta, particularly Sadat agglomeration, and one for coastal/border zone, particularly Damietta agglomeration. Meanwhile, at the local level, GoPP has revised development plans for Greater Cairo, encompassing southern entrance of Giza and Al-Moneeb Square as well as min—a significant development initiative aimed at providing affordable housing.

## UNDP and the UN in Egypt

UNDP has led several training sessions for all UN staff in Egypt on planning joint workplans, setting joint indicators for the UNSDCF, and results-based reporting. In collaboration with UN Women and the National Council for Women, UNDP rolled out the 'African Women's Climate Adaptive Priorities,' a COP 27 presidency initiative. This initiative involved mobilizing technical experts to propose an action plan for guiding African governments toward the 2030 net zero target, with a focus on gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls in a changing climate. Furthermore, UNDP partnered with UNIDO and ILO on the "Egypt Youth Employment: Providing a Reason to Stay" Program, alongside MSMEDA and the Ministry of Trade and Industry. This program enhanced MSMEDA's quality and delivery of non-financial services. Additionally, in collaboration with UNICEF, ILO, UNCTAD, UN Women, and RCO, UNDP provided technical support for Egypt's Integrated National Financing Framework, a flagship SDG Joint Fund project. This partnership explored new areas for UN agencies, including gender-based budgeting, climate tagging, social floor costing, illicit financial flows, and local-level budgeting. UNDP also co-chairs the Livelihoods and Economic Inclusion working group with UNHCR, as part of the Inter-sector Working Groups under the Refugee Coordination Mechanism in Egypt, addressing the Sudan Refugee Response Plan and the Regional Refugee and Resilience Plan in response to Syria (3RP). Additionally, UNDP is represented in the Interagency Humanitarian Coordination Group in Egypt, led by OCHA, amid the Gaza war.

# FUTURE IN ACTION



# DID YOU KNOW

- There were more conflicts worldwide in 2023 than in any single year since World War II
- 70+ elections in 2024 give over half the world's population a chance to vote
- Not a single indicator for SDG5, gender equality, has been met - or even "almost" met. A quarter of people worldwide believe it is justifiable for a man to beat his wife
- 2023 investments in renewable energy outpaced those in fossil fuels for the first time, reaching $2.8 trillion
- Finance to nature-based solutions increased from $150 bn (2021) to $154 bn (2022) – though still less than half the $384 bn needed
- AI-powered misinformation is the world's biggest short-term threat, according to the World Economic Forum
- Less than a third (27%) of people in low-income countries used the internet in 2023
- The cloud has a bigger carbon footprint than the airline industry
- It's anyone's guess: estimates of 'climate migrants' by 2050 range from 25 million to 1 billion
- 2023 is set to be the warmest year on record - and El Niño will likely make 2024 even hotter
- 50% of the world's population is under 30. The average age of leaders is 62
- 2023 saw a notable increase in protests across the world, with new protests in 83 countries



# LOOKING AHEAD

Entering 2024, UNDP reaffirms its commitment to close collaboration with the government, alongside UN agencies, international and national development partners, to guide Egypt towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals and Egypt Vision 2030.

Recognizing the necessity of enhanced collective action and seizing development opportunities amidst crises, our primary focus in Egypt remains on bolstering social and economic resilience for the most vulnerable communities, ensuring inclusivity for all.

Furthermore, we will continue our support for SMEs as pivotal drivers of economic resilience, especially as they transition towards digital and environmentally sustainable practices. Our initiatives will encompass biodiversity conservation, agrifood systems, and tourism development, with due consideration of disaster and climate risks in our planning.

Moreover, UNDP will channel efforts towards fostering green financing opportunities to mobilize funding, collaborating closely with key institutions and investors engaged in Egypt's green transition sectors, including energy, water, waste, and biodiversity preservation.

Looking ahead, our policy advocacy and governance efforts will prioritize accelerating SDG integration and financing, enhancing e-government services, and enhancing local service delivery mechanisms.

Navigating challenges and building on successes, we are committed to continuing our efforts in empowering communities and steering towards a sustainable future, all while prioritizing the well-being of both people and the planet.

# DONORS AND PARTNERS

OUR WORK WOULD NOT BE POSSIBLE WITHOUT THE GENEROUS SUPPORT OF

### GOVERNMENT PARTNERS

- The Government of Egypt
- Ministry of Foreign Affairs
- Information and Decision Support Center (IDSC)
- Institute of National Planning (INP)
- Ministry of Health and Population
- Ministry of Communication and Information Technology
- Ministry of Social Solidarity
- Ministry of Environment
- Egyptian Environmental Affairs Agency
- Ministry of Local Development
- Ministry of Planning and Economic Development
- Ministry of Youth and Sports
- Ministry of International Cooperation
- Ministry of Water Resources and Irrigation
- Ministry of Trade and Industry
- Ministry of Tourism
- Ministry of Electricity
- Egypt Post
- Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise Development Agency (MSMEDA)
- Financial Regulatory Authority
- Egyptian Meteorological Authority
- Egyptian Tax Authority
- National Council for Women (NCW)
- National Telecom Regulatory Authority (NTRA)
- Information Technology Industry Development Agency (ITIDA)

### TOP CORE CONTRIBUTORS

- Finland
- Qatar
- New Zealand
- Norway
- Canada
- Sweden
- Korea
- Switzerland
- Italy
- Spain
- Denmark
- Germany
- Netherlands
- France
- Japan

### DEVELOPMENT PARTNERS

- Green Climate Fund
- Global Environment Facility
- Global Fund for Coral Reefs
- The Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria
- Montreal Protocol
- The European Union
- USAID
- UN in Egypt
- Agence Francaise De Developpement (AFD)
- ITA-EGY Debt for Development Swap Programme
- African Climate Foundation (ACF)

### PRIVATE SECTOR, CSOS, FOUNDATIONS

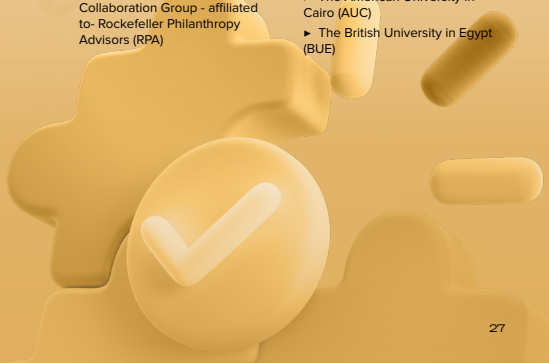
- Sawiris Foundation
- Commercial International Bank (CIB)
- African Development Bank
- Microsoft
- Mideast Communication Systems (MCS)
- Climate Emergency Collaboration Group - affiliated to- Rockefeller Philanthropy Advisors (RPA)
- Knowledge Economy Foundation (KEF)
- EFG Hermes Foundation
- The Egyptian Red Crescent
- The Big Heart Foundation
- Egyptian Food Bank
- AmCham
- El Nidaa Foundation

### CATALYST

- Misr El Kheir
- Education Above all

### ACADEMIA

- The American University in Cairo (AUC)
- The British University in Egypt (BUE)





**UNDP Egypt Country Office**
United Nations Development Programme
World Trade Center, 1191 Corniche El Nile
Cairo, Egypt

www.undp.org

© UNDP 2024